Porirua U3A Inc

Newsletter February 2026

Kia ora to all U3A members

Happy New Year to you all. It has been a changeable summer and as I write this, I look out the window to see rain, rain, rain!! Now I am looking forward to the long weekend and more summery weather conditions.

By now some of the interest groups would have met and we are keen to hear how they are progressing.

Note from Bill Gebbie (President)

Dear Members
I attended the Tawa U3A AGM a couple of weeks ago and was very impressed at the programme they have for 2026 and encourage you to sign up for courses that interest you. There are also interesting and topical seminars planned. Our close relationship brings benefits to both sets of members, and our trip to the Trentham races and our tour of Porirua's op shops included members from both U3As. Both trips were lots of fun although our groups were small. Don't forget to put 6 at Pirates Cove on Tuesday 17 February in your diary, for an evening of mini-golf.
There are some new interest groups this year, including Te Reo classes run by one of our members, and music appreciation run by Tawa U3A). We have so much to choose from.
The more members we have the more opportunities we can provide so please encourage your friends and family to join us. For a mere $15 members have access to all that we and Tawa offer,
I hope you're all well. Don't hesitate to get in touch with any ideas or feedback you have.

With good wishes
Bill Gebbie

The quarterly meeting on Thursday 19th February 2026 is held at:

<u>The Auditorium,</u> North Baptist Church at 69f Discovery Drive, Whitby, Porirua 5024

This meeting will begin at **12.45pm** and will be held in the Auditorium. The reason for this is that there are renovations occurring in the kitchen beside the hall. This also means that there will be no shared lunch nor any refreshments available. The meeting will begin with the speaker at 1.00pm and we ask that you all be seated before then.

Guest Speaker for the Quarterly Meeting

Rhonda Pritchard, a Wellington psychologist and counsellor.

The title of her talk is: Love in later life

What is the reality of the personal and intimate lives of older people; married, solo or in close relationships of various kinds? What are the stages, changes and challenges, shaking the foundations and framework of the earlier relationship, that we face?

Counsellor, writer and researcher Rhonda Pritchard will examine common beliefs and assumptions about marriage and other forms of close relationships for older people, what research has uncovered and what her own experience and close observation has revealed.

Rhonda Pritchard, a graduate of both Victoria and Waikato Universities, has 40 years' experience of working with couples and families. She has undertaken research on separation, violence and homicide in families, is the author of four books on family relationships including Love in the Real World and was recipient of the Distinguished Service Award of the New Zealand Association of Counsellors. She has been a columnist on ethical issues for the New Zealand Psychological Society and Member of the New Zealand Parole Board for seven years

An invitation to participate in research:

The Emotion, Lifespan, and Memory (ELM) Group in the School of Psychology at Victoria University is currently running a study that is looking at the relationship between memory and wellbeing for adults aged 65 and older. This study has been granted ethics approval by the VUW Human Ethics Committee #HE040233

We are looking for New Zealanders 65 and older to take part in an online study looking at memory, health and well-being. Want to know more visit our website:**https://elm-group.org or scan the QR code.**

Communications and Sharing information: If you have any matters which you want to bring to the meeting please be in touch with Christine Healy or Bill Gebbie via email. poriruau3a@gmail.com or talk with one of the following committee members

Executive Committee 20245/2026

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Paula van Wijmen Committee (021 181 8584)

We look forward to seeing you all at the 1st Quarterly meeting on 19th February 2026. Please note the change in time and location for this meeting.

Christine Healy

Secretary

Porirua U3A (INC)

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